

SEBASTIAN

Prithee, say on:  
The setting of thine eye and cheek proclaim  
A matter from thee, and a birth indeed  
Which throes thee much to yield.

ANTONIO

Thus, sir:  
Although this lord of weak remembrance, this,  
Who shall be of as little memory  
When he is earth'd, hath here almost persuade,—  
For he's a spirit of persuasion, only  
Professes to persuade,—the king his son's alive,  
'Tis as impossible that he's undrown'd  
And he that sleeps here swims.

SEBASTIAN

I have no hope  
That he's undrown'd.

ANTONIO

O, out of that 'no hope'  
What great hope have you! no hope that way is  
Another way so high a hope that even  
Ambition cannot pierce a wink beyond,  
But doubt discovery there. Will you grant with me  
That Ferdinand is drown'd?

SEBASTIAN

He's gone.

ANTONIO

Then, tell me,  
Who's the next heir of Naples?

SEBASTIAN

Claribel.

ANTONIO

She that is queen of Tunis; she that dwells  
Ten leagues beyond man's life; she that from Naples  
Can have no note, unless the sun were post—  
The man i' the moon's too slow—till new-born chins  
Be rough and razorable; she that—from whom?  
We all were sea-swallow'd, though some cast again,  
And by that destiny to perform an act  
Whereof what's past is prologue, what to come  
In yours and my discharge.

SEBASTIAN

What stuff is this! how say you?  
'Tis true, my brother's daughter's queen of Tunis;  
So is she heir of Naples; 'twixt which regions  
There is some space.

ANTONIO

A space whose every cubit  
Seems to cry out, 'How shall that Claribel  
Measure us back to Naples? Keep in Tunis,  
And let Sebastian wake.' Say, this were death  
That now hath seized them; why, they were no worse  
Than now they are. There be that can rule Naples  
As well as he that sleeps; lords that can prate  
As amply and unnecessarily  
As this Gonzalo; I myself could make  
A chough of as deep chat. O, that you bore  
The mind that I do! what a sleep were this  
For your advancement! Do you understand me?

SEBASTIAN

Metinks I do.

ANTONIO

And how does your content  
Tender your own good fortune?

SEBASTIAN  
I remember  
You did supplant your brother Prospero.

ANTONIO  
True:  
And look how well my garments sit upon me;  
Much feater than before: my brother's servants  
Were then my fellows; now they are my men.

SEBASTIAN  
But, for your conscience?

ANTONIO  
Ay, sir; where lies that? if 'twere a kibe,  
'Twould put me to my slipper: but I feel not  
This deity in my bosom: twenty consciences,  
That stand 'twixt me and Milan, candied be they  
And melt ere they molest! Here lies your brother,  
No better than the earth he lies upon,  
If he were that which now he's like, that's dead;  
Whom I, with this obedient steel, three inches of it,  
Can lay to bed for ever; whiles you, doing thus,  
To the perpetual wink for aye might put  
This ancient morsel, this Sir Prudence, who  
Should not upbraid our course. For all the rest,  
They'll take suggestion as a cat laps milk;  
They'll tell the clock to any business that  
We say befits the hour.

SEBASTIAN  
Thy case, dear friend,  
Shall be my precedent; as thou got'st Milan,  
I'll come by Naples. Draw thy sword: one stroke  
Shall free thee from the tribute which thou payest;  
And I the king shall love thee.

This is a strange repose, to be asleep  
With eyes wide open; standing, speaking, moving,  
And yet so fast asleep.

ANTONIO  
Noble Sebastian,  
Thou let'st thy fortune sleep—die, rather; wink'st  
Whiles thou art waking.

SEBASTIAN  
Thou dost snore distinctly;  
There's meaning in thy snores.

ANTONIO  
I am more serious than my custom: you  
Must be so too, if heed me; which to do  
Trebles thee o'er.

SEBASTIAN  
Well, I am standing water.

ANTONIO  
I'll teach you how to flow.

SEBASTIAN  
Do so: to ebb  
Hereditary sloth instructs me.

ANTONIO  
O,  
If you but knew how you the purpose cherish  
Whiles thus you mock it! how, in stripping it,  
You more invest it! Ebbing men, indeed,  
Most often do so near the bottom run  
By their own fear or sloth.



SEBASTIAN

Why

Dost it not then our eyelids sink? I find not  
Myself disposed to sleep.

ANTONIO

Nor I; my spirits are nimble.  
They fell together all, as by consent;  
They dropp'd, as by a thunder-stroke. What might,  
Worthy Sebastian? O, what might!—No more:—  
And yet me thinks I see it in thy face,  
What thou shouldst be: the occasion speaks thee, and  
My strong imagination sees a crown  
Dropping upon thy head.

SEBASTIAN

What, art thou waking?

ANTONIO

Do you not hear me speak?

SEBASTIAN

I do; and surely  
It is a sleepy language and thou speak'st  
Out of thy sleep. What is it thou didst say?

ANTONIO

Draw together;  
And when I rear my hand, do you the like,  
To fall it on Gonzalo.  
*(They draw their swords.)*

SEBASTIAN

O, but one word.

*(They talk apart.)*

*(Re-enter ARIEL, invisible.)*

ARIEL

My master through his art foresees the danger  
That you, his friend, are in; and sends me forth—  
For else his project dies—to keep them living.  
*(Sings in GONZALO'S ear.)*

*While you here do snoring lie,  
Open-eyed conspiracy  
His time doth take.  
If of life you keep a care,  
Shake off slumber, and beware:  
Awake, awake!*

ANTONIO

*(To SEBASTIAN)*  
Then let us both be sudden.

GONZALO

*(Waking)* Now, good angels  
Preserve the king.  
*(He wakes ALONSO.)*

ALONSO

*(To SEBASTIAN)*  
Why, how now? ho, awake! Why are you drawn?  
Wherefore this ghastly looking?



ANTONIO

*(To Gonzalo)*

Nay, good my lord, be not angry.

GONZALO

No, I warrant you; I will not adventure my discretion so weakly. Will you laugh me asleep, for I am very heavy?

ANTONIO

Go sleep, and hear us.

*(All sleep except Alonso, Sebastian, and Antonio.)*

ALONSO

What, all so soon asleep! I wish mine eyes  
Would, with themselves, shut up my thoughts: I find  
They are inclined to do so.

SEBASTIAN

Please you, sir,  
Do not omit the heavy offer of it:  
It seldom visits sorrow; when it doth,  
It is a comforter.

ANTONIO

We two, my lord,  
Will guard your person while you take your rest,  
And watch your safety.

ALONSO

Thank you. Wondrous heavy.

*(Alonso sleeps.)*

*(Exit ARIEL.)*

SEBASTIAN

What a strange drowsiness possesses them!

ANTONIO

It is the quality o' the climate.



SEBASTIAN  
God save his majesty!

ANTONIO  
Long live Gonzalo!

GONZALO  
And,—do you mark me, sir?

ALONSO  
Prithce, no more: thou dost talk nothing to me.

GONZALO  
I do well believe your highness; and did it to minister occasion to these gentlemen, who are of such sensible and nimble lungs that they always use to laugh at nothing.

ANTONIO  
’Twas you we laughed at.

GONZALO  
Who in this kind of merry fooling am nothing to you: so you may continue and laugh at nothing still.

ANTONIO  
What a blow was there given!

SEBASTIAN  
An it had not fallen flat-long.

GONZALO  
You are gentlemen of brave metal; you would lift the moon out of her sphere, if she would continue in it five weeks without changing.  
(*Enter ARIEL, INVISIBLE and PLAYING SOLEMN MUSIC.*)

SEBASTIAN  
We would so, and then go a bat-fowling.

GONZALO  
(*To SEBASTIAN*)  
What’s the matter?

SEBASTIAN  
Whiles we stood here securing your repose,  
Even now, we heard a hollow burst of bellowing  
Like bulls, or rather lions: did’t not wake you?  
It struck mine ear most terribly.

ALONSO  
I heard nothing.

ANTONIO  
O, ’twas a din to fright a monster’s ear,  
To make an earthquake! sure, it was the roar  
Of a whole herd of lions.

ALONSO  
Heard you this, Gonzalo?

GONZALO  
Upon mine honour, sir, I heard a humming,  
And that a strange one too, which did awake me:  
I shook you, sir, and cried: as mine eyes open’d,  
I saw their weapons drawn: there was a noise,  
That’s verily. ’Tis best we stand upon our guard,  
Or that we quit this place; let’s draw our weapons.

ALONSO  
Lead off this ground; and let’s make further search  
For my poor son.

GONZALO  
Heavens keep him from these beasts!  
For he is, sure, i’ the island.

ALONSO  
Lead away.

ARIEL  
Prospero my lord shall know what I have done:  
So, king, go safely on to seek thy son.  
(*Exeunt omnes.*)

SEBASTIAN  
'Scape being drunk for want of wine.

GONZALO  
If the commonwealth I would by contraries  
Execute all things; for no kind of traffic  
Would I admit; no name of magistrate;  
Letters should not be known; riches, poverty,  
And use of service, none; contract, succession,  
Bourn, bound of land, tilth, vineyard, none;  
No use of metal, corn, or wine, or oil;  
No occupation; all men idle, all;  
And women too, but innocent and pure;  
No sovereignty;—

SEBASTIAN  
Yet he would be king on't.

ANTONIO  
The latter end of his commonwealth forgets the beginning.

GONZALO  
All things in common nature should produce  
Without sweat or endeavour: treason, felony,  
Sword, pike, knife, gun, or need of any engine,  
Would I not have; but nature should bring forth,  
Of its own kind, all foison, all abundance,  
To feed my innocent people.

SEBASTIAN  
No marrying 'mong his subjects?

ANTONIO  
None, man; all idle: whores and knaves.

GONZALO  
I would with such perfection govern, sir,  
To excel the golden age.



ALONSO  
So is the dear'st o' the loss.

GONZALO  
My lord Sebastian,  
The truth you speak doth lack some gentleness  
And time to speak it in: you rub the sore,  
When you should bring the plaster.

SEBASTIAN  
Very well.

ANTONIO  
And most chirurgically.

GONZALO  
*(To ALONSO)*  
It is foul weather in us all, good sir,  
When you are cloudy.

SEBASTIAN  
Foul weather?

ANTONIO  
Very foul.

GONZALO  
Had I plantation of this isle, my lord,—

ANTONIO  
He'd sow't with nettle-seed.

SEBASTIAN  
Or docks, or mallows.

GONZALO  
And were the king on't, what would I do?



## Scene 2

*Another part of the island.*

*(Enter CALIBAN with a burden of wood. A noise of thunder heard.)*

CALIBAN

All the infections that the sun sucks up  
From bogs, fens, flats, on Prosper fall and make him  
By inch-meal a disease! His spirits hear me  
And yet I needs must curse. But they'll not pinch,  
Fight me with urchin—shows, pitch me i' the mire,  
Nor lead me, like a firebrand, in the dark  
Out of my way, unless he bid 'em; but  
For every trifle are they set upon me;  
Sometime like apes that mow and chatter at me  
And after bite me, then like hedgehogs which  
Lie tumbling in my barefoot way and mount  
Their pricks at my footfall; sometime am I

All wound with adders who with cloven tongues  
Do hiss me into madness.

*(Enter TRINCULO.)*

Lo, now, lo!

Here comes a spirit of his, and to torment me  
For bringing wood in slowly. I'll fall flat;  
Perchance he will not mind me.

TRINCULO

Here's neither bush nor shrub, to bear off any weather at all, and  
another storm brewing; I hear it sing i' the wind: yond same black cloud,  
yond huge one, looks like a foul bombard that would shed his liquor. If  
it should thunder as it did before, I know not where to hide my head:  
yond same cloud cannot choose but fall by painfuls. What have we here?  
a man or a fish? dead or alive? A fish: he smells like a fish; a very ancient  
and fish-like smell; a kind of not of the newest Poor-John. A strange fish!  
Were I in England now, as once I was, and had but this fish painted, not  
a holiday fool there but would give a piece of silver: there would this  
monster make a man; any strange beast there makes a man: when they  
will not give a doit to relieve a lame beggar, they will lay out ten to see a  
dead Indian. Legged like a man and his fins like arms! Warm o' my  
troth! I do now let loose my opinion; hold it no longer: this is no fish,  
but an islander, that hath lately suffered by a thunderbolt.

*(Thunder.)*

Alas, the storm is come again! my best way is to creep under his  
gaberdine; there is no other shelter hereabouts: misery acquaints a man  
with strange bed-fellows. I will here shroud till the dregs of the storm be  
past.

*(Enter STEPHANO, singing: a bottle in his hand.)*

STEPHANO

*I shall no more to sea, to sea,  
Here shall I die ashore—*

FRANCISCO

Sir, he may live:  
I saw him beat the surges under him,  
And ride upon their backs; he trod the water,  
Whose enmity he flung aside, and breasted  
The surge most swoln that met him; his bold head  
'Bove the contentious waves he kept, and oar'd  
Himself with his good arms in lusty stroke  
To the shore, that o'er his wave-worn basis bow'd,  
As stooping to relieve him: I not doubt  
He came alive to land.

ALONSO

No, no, he's gone.

SEBASTIAN

Sir, you may thank yourself for this great loss,  
That would not bless our Europe with your daughter,  
But rather lose her to an African;  
Where she at least is banish'd from your eye,  
Who hath cause to wet the grief on't.

ALONSO

Prithce, peace.

SEBASTIAN

You were kneel'd to and importuned otherwise  
By all of us, and the fair soul herself  
Weigh'd between loathness and obedience, at  
Which end o' the beam should bow. We have lost your son,  
I fear, for ever. Milan and Naples have  
More widows in them of this business' making  
Than we bring men to comfort them:  
The fault's your own.